

December 10, 2025

Marcus Allen				
North Carolina				
Cornerback				
Height: 6020	Weight: 190	Year: 4SR	Jersey #: 29	Hometown: Marietta, GA
Games Reviewed: 2025 Virginia, Stanford, Wake Forest, NC State				
2025 Stats:				
Career Stats:				
Scouting Report by: Danny Nolan				

Critical Factors					
Reactive Athleticism		Play Speed		Ball Skills	
6		6		6	
Positional Factors					
Off-Man	Press Man	Zone Coverage	Slot Coverage	Transition	Closing Speed
5	6	5	5	5	6
FBI	Mental Tough	Open-Field Tack	Play Strength	Run Support	ST Value
5	5	4	4	3	5

Strengths

- Ball skills
- Man coverage downfield
- Closing speed and ability to recover

Weaknesses

- Strength and physicality as a tackler
- Use of hands in the pass game
- Inconsistent motor

Overall

Senior Marcus Allen is a long, fast cornerback at the University of North Carolina. Allen plays almost exclusively outside and typically lines up on the right side of the defense. He splits his time evenly between off-ball defense and press coverage. He looks a tad more comfortable in man but is far from a liability in zone. Allen has spent his whole collegiate career as a Tar Heel, starting 38 of the 44 games he has appeared in. He has impressive long speed and, even when initially beat, can catch up to receivers downfield. His 6'2" frame means that only the tallest receivers have a size advantage over him. Jump balls thrown Allen's way should not be a concern. Allen's toughness may as well be decided by a coin flip. When he's angry, Allen is as physical as they come. However, he looks disinterested in assisting on tackles far too often.

Pass Game

In the pass game, Allen sports serious potential. He demonstrates the ability to blanket receivers both across the field and on deep routes. He will be beaten by the quickest releases but can usually recover soon enough to prevent an easy pitch and catch. He brings good ball skills to the table, as he can break up and intercept passes with no issue. Allen can be too aggressive with his hands, so holding and pass interference penalties could be a weakness of his. His average footwork exacerbates this issue. Sometimes he can change directions fluidly, but other times he might slip or allow too big of a cushion for the receiver. An ultra-physical WR will give Allen some trouble, both during the route and after the catch. Big-bodied receivers should be able to break his tackle attempts easily. Allen's best trait as a zone defender is his closing speed. When a pass-catcher has settled into a soft spot in the zone, Allen can quickly put himself in position for a pass breakup or tackle. He is intelligent in coverage, maintaining inside leverage in man and staying disciplined in zone. Allen doesn't profile as a slot corner, but he could handle the task if a bigger receiver lines up inside.

Run Game

Allen is not a strong contributor against the run. His open-field tackling ability is lackluster, and he doesn't want to get his hands dirty on inside runs. If he thinks a tackle is secured by a teammate, he won't rush over to help out. He struggles to free himself from blocks out wide and is thus taken out of the play relatively easily. While not used as a blitzer much as a Tar Heel, his speed and length could make him valuable if unblocked.

Last Word

At the next level, Allen profiles as a fringe starter best suited for man coverage. He likely won't have consistent inside-outside flexion, but could potentially have a role in nickel or dime packages, pushing an outside corner into the slot. He should be on the field often for third

downs and obvious passing situations, and should be left on the sidelines for clear rushing scenarios. If Allen can dial in his motor and toughness, he could be an important contributor on special teams.

One-Liner: Allen brings NFL-caliber coverage and ball skills to the field, and an improvement in strength and toughness could make him a well-rounded starting cornerback.

Grade: 6.4 - Ceiling: 6.7 (10%) Floor: 5.8 (10%) Round: UDFA